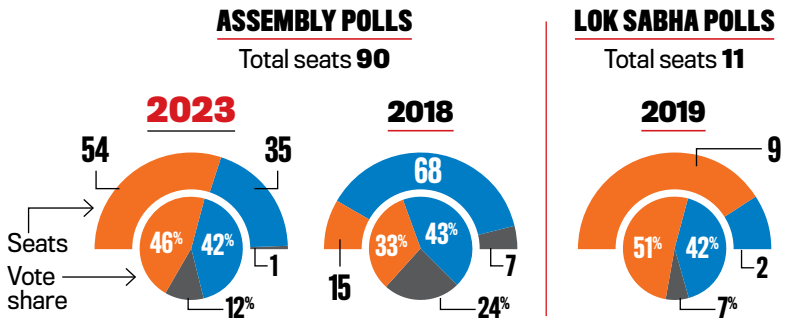
HOW THE TWO PARTIES FARED



Assembly	SC seats 10	ST seats 29
2023 ▶	4 / 6	17 / 11 / 1
2018 ▶	2 / 7 / 1	3 / 25 / 1

● BJP ● Congress ● Others

Source: Election Commission of India

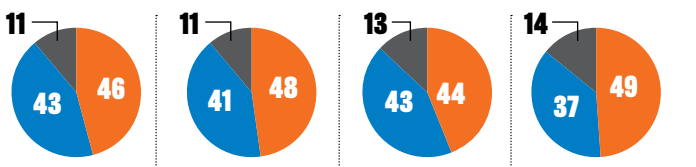
EDUCATION

NO SCHOOL (11%)	48 / 51 / 1
UP TO 9TH (25%)	45 / 44 / 11
10TH PASS (18%)	47 / 42 / 11
12TH PASS (24%)*	46 / 42 / 12
GRADUATE (15%)	50 / 38 / 12
PG (5%)	44 / 42 / 14
PROF. DEGREES (1%)	51 / 39 / 10

OCCUPATION

UNEMPLOYED (7%)	47 / 42 / 11
LABOUR (26%)	46 / 43 / 11
FARMER (24%)	45 / 42 / 13
SKILLED JOBS (6%)	48 / 42 / 10
SMALL SHOPS (2%)	50 / 41 / 9
HOUSEWIVES (15%)	49 / 40 / 11
PVT SERVICE (7%)	48 / 41 / 11
GOVT SERVICE (1%)	46 / 43 / 11

MONTHLY FAMILY INCOME



THE BJP SUCCEEDED IN WINNING THE OBC VOTE BACK, GETTING 55 PER CENT OF THE YADAV VOTE, 53 PER CENT KURMI VOTES AND 62 PER CENT SAHU VOTES

to married women. Though the BJP did initially struggle to popularise these schemes right before the first phase of polling, by the second phase, they got enough recall and brought the party much support, especially from women.

WINNING THE SOPS WAR

The Congress, on its part, announced additional sops too—a second farm loan waiver, Rs 15,000 to women annually to counter the BJP's Mahtari scheme, and a revised paddy procurement rate of Rs 3,200 a quintal—but they didn't have the desired effect. According to the India Today Axis My India poll, the BJP's vote share among women jumped to 48 per cent, up from 34 per cent in 2018, while the Congress's decreased to 41 per cent from 44 per cent last time.

The net result of its poll strategy was that not only did the BJP sweep the tribal North and South, but it also won a majority of the seats in the plains—32 out of 64, including most urban seats. Its Hindutva plank played a key role here too. "Anti-Muslim sentiment was played up in central Chhattisgarh, so that out of 23 seats in Raipur, Bilaspur, Durg, Kawardha, Mungeli, Bemetara districts, the Congress won only two," says Shrivastava. The BJP also succeeded in winning the OBC vote back, getting 55 per cent of the Yadav vote, 53 per cent Kurmi votes and 62 per cent Sahu votes. Among the remaining backward classes, the party secured 60 per cent votes, up from 44 per cent in 2018.

The SCs, however, especially the Satnamis, the biggest group in that category, remained largely loyal to the Congress. But the BJP did make marginal gains, indicating that some Congress support was chipped away. Against two out of 10 SC seats in 2018, the BJP won four this time.

If anything, this election was a lesson against political short-sightedness for the Congress. Ignoring tribals, urban areas and internal friction within the party, and focusing all its energy on the OBC vote is what cost the Grand Old Party dearly despite being in the pole position. ■